Melbourne metro trains: where and when demand is highest

FY2024-25 · DTP modelled passenger counts

Month: All

Day type: All

Avg boardings per normal weekday

753K

Share of boardings in AM peak (07:00–09:00)

21.4%

Busiest line (total boardings)

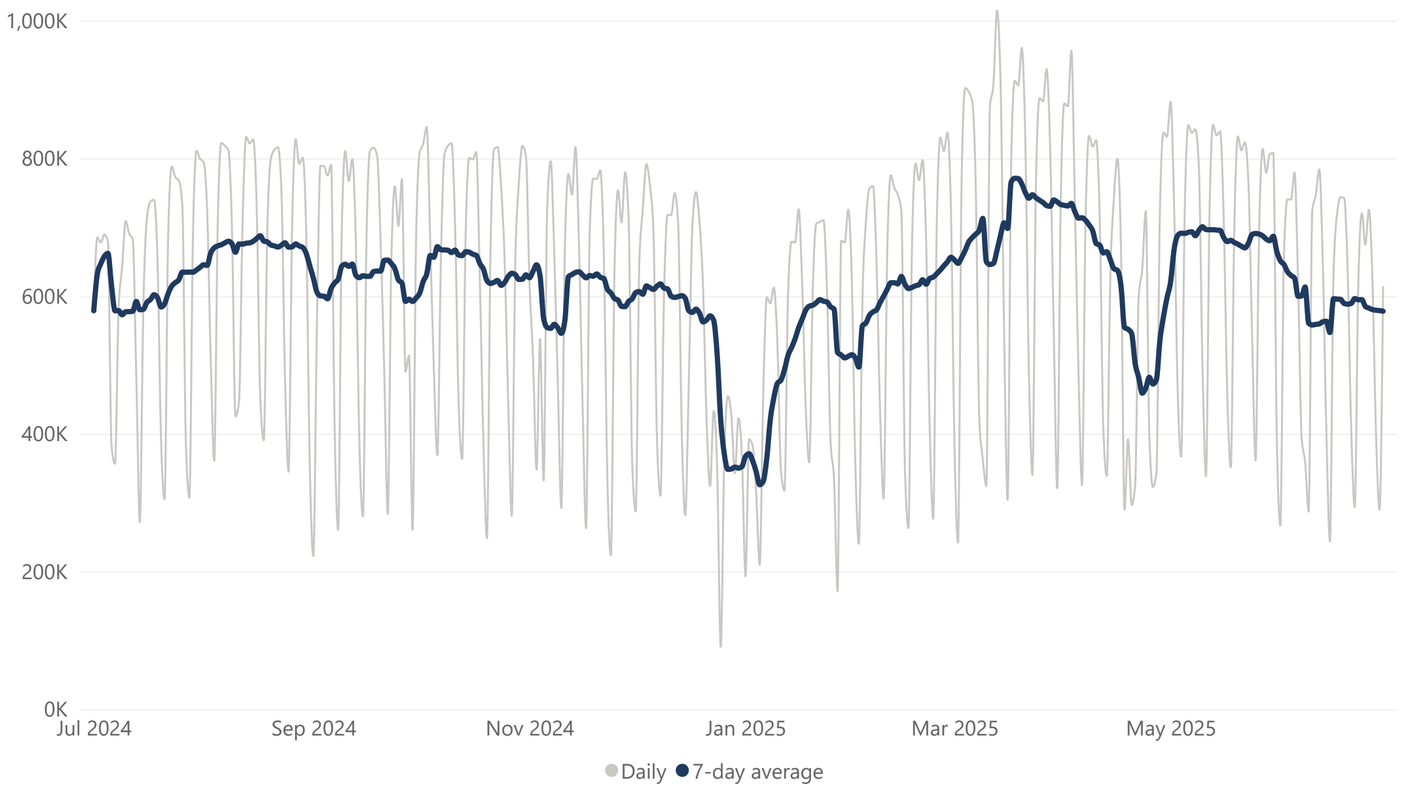
Pakenham

Forecast error (WAPE), Apr–Jun back-test

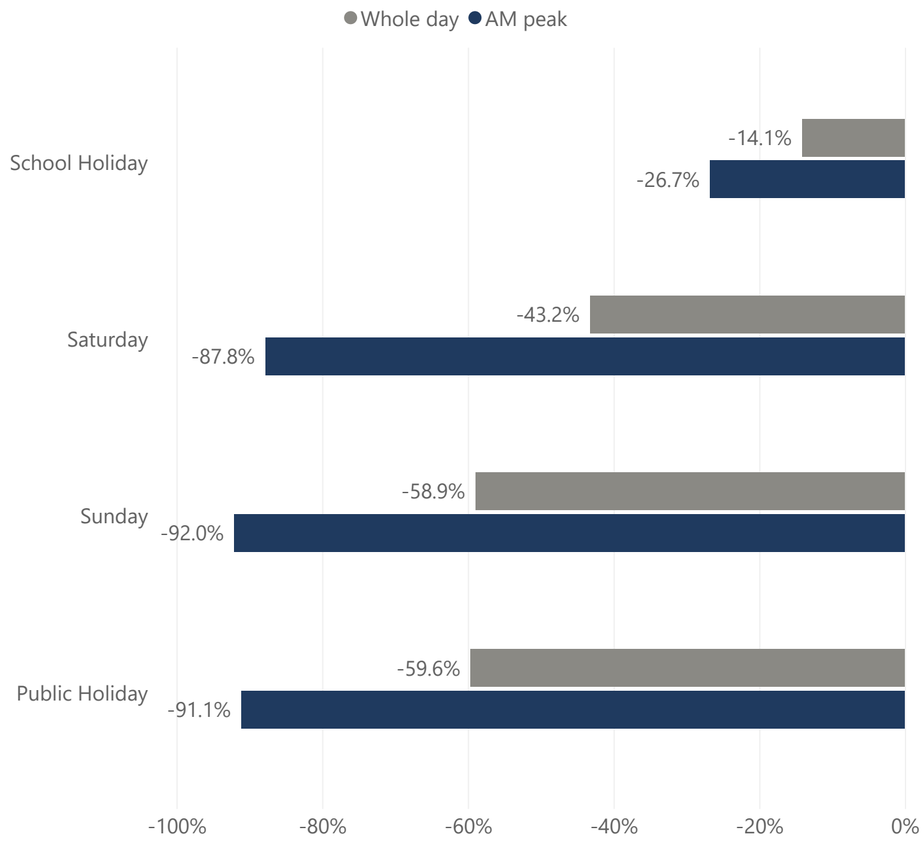
8.0%

Baseline **16.2%**

Demand peaks in March and halves over Christmas (passengers per day)



Weekend commuting almost disappears (vs a normal weekday)



Source: DTP Train Service Passenger Counts FY2024-25 (modelled estimates, CC BY 4.0). Boardings count every train a passenger takes, including transfers.

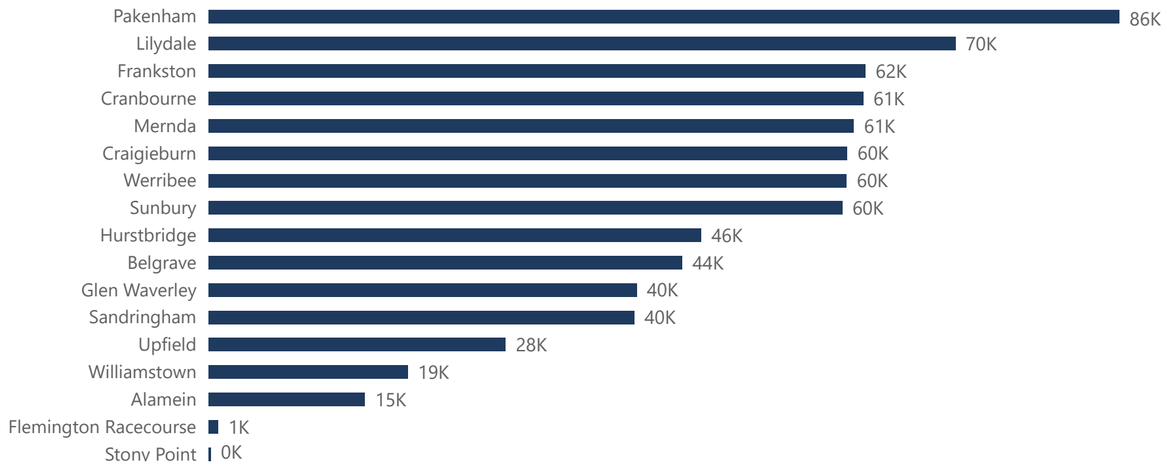
Lines and stations: where and when demand concentrates

Boardings per day, FY2024-25 · choose a day type and line

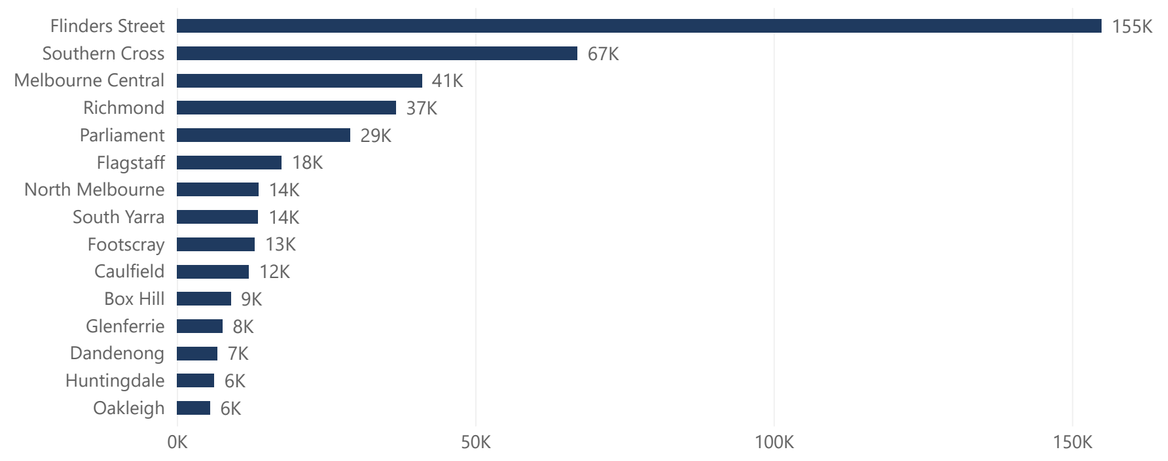
Day type: Normal Weekday

Line: All

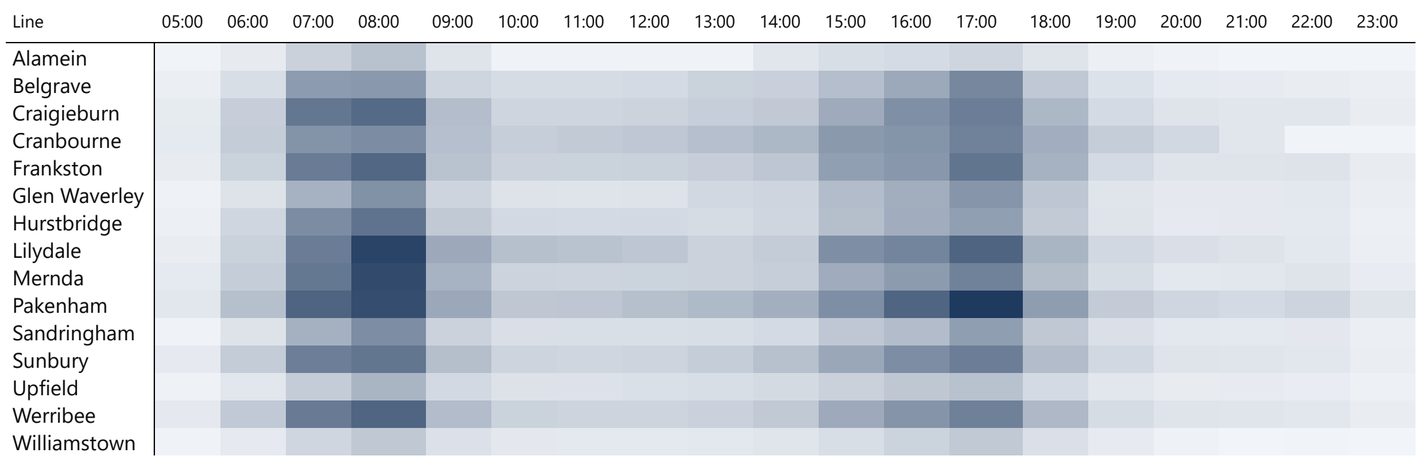
Boardings per day by line (all stations on the line)



Top 15 stations: boardings per day



When each line is busiest: boardings per day by departure hour



10 most crowded services (avg peak load, normal weekdays)

#	Line	Train	Departs	Fullest at	Time	Avg peak load
1	Sunbury	6626	07:53	Footscray	08:29	1,046
2	Craigieburn	5842	07:53	Kensington	08:24	999
3	Craigieburn	5838	07:39	Kensington	08:10	964
4	Craigieburn	5836	07:30	Kensington	08:01	932
5	Pakenham	C032	07:19	Caulfield	08:20	883
6	Cranbourne	C428	07:38	Caulfield	08:23	881
7	Pakenham	C034	07:35	Richmond	08:47	878
8	Craigieburn	5840	07:45	Kensington	08:16	864
9	Werribee	6426	07:59	Footscray	08:25	862
10	Werribee	6424	07:49	Newport	08:09	851

Source: DTP Train Service Passenger Counts FY2024-25 (modelled estimates, CC BY 4.0). DTP's model has no capacity limit: read high loads as 'very crowded', not exact counts.

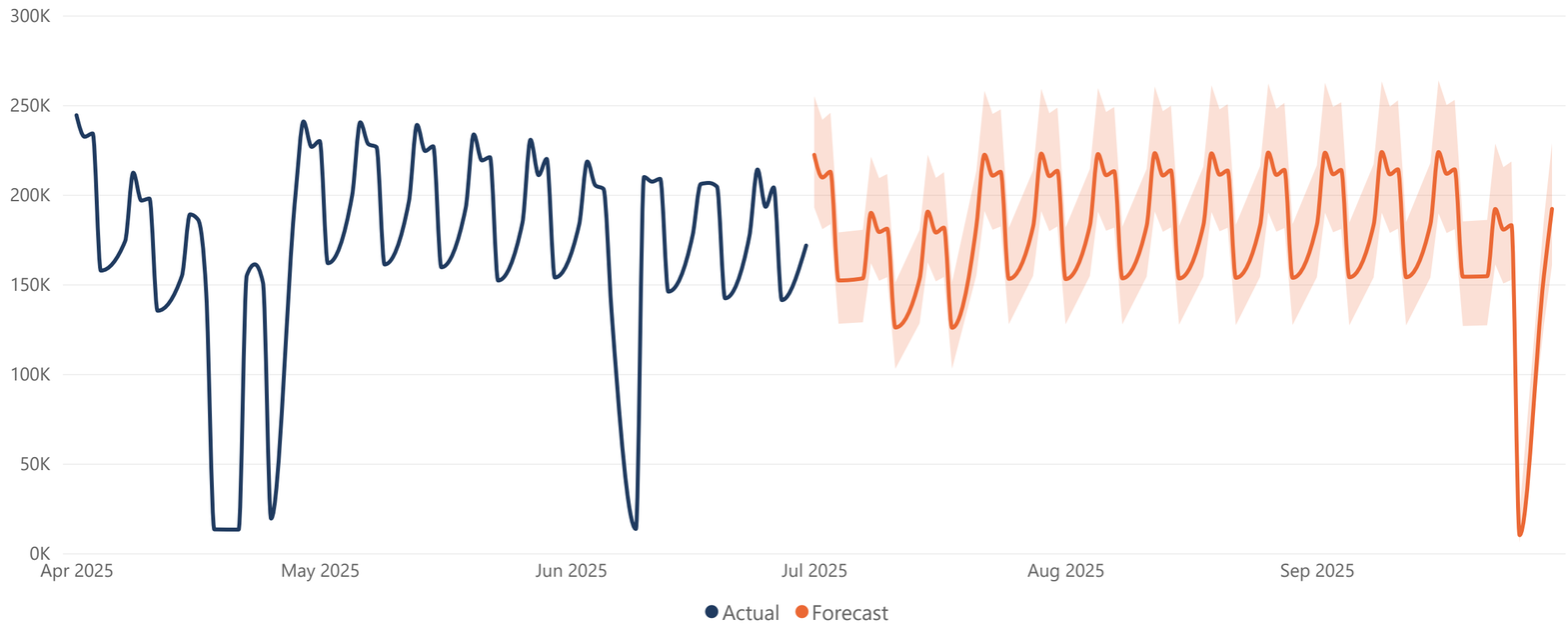
Forecast: weekday AM peak demand, Jul–Sep 2025

15 lines · average of Prophet and SARIMAX models · back-tested on Apr–Jun 2025

Line

All

Next quarter looks flat: weekday AM peak boardings, actual Apr–Jun, forecast Jul–Sep 2025



Forecast AM peak boardings per normal weekday, Jul–Sep 2025

197K

Forecast error (WAPE), Apr–Jun back-test

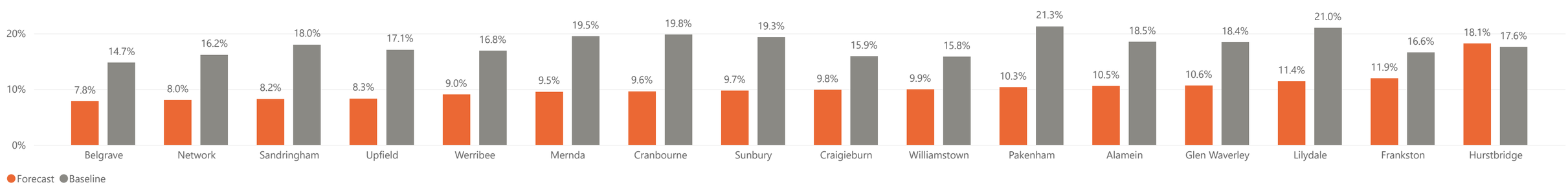
8.0%

Baseline **16.2%**

Key Findings

1. **Next quarter looks flat:** about 197k AM peak boardings on a normal weekday across the 15 lines (80% range 167k–231k). School holiday weekdays are about 14% lower.
2. **The forecast halves the error of a "same as last week" baseline** (8.0% vs 16.2% at network level). Most of the gain is on public and school holidays.
3. **Treat it as a planning range, not a point.** One year of data means no seasonal pattern: official figures dipped about 2% in Jul–Sep 2025. It was also built before the Metro Tunnel opened.

The forecast beats the baseline on 14 of 15 lines: back-test error by line, Apr–Jun 2025 (WAPE, lower is better)



Source: DTP Train Service Passenger Counts FY2024-25 and DTP monthly patronage (CC BY 4.0). Forecast refitted on Jul 2024 – Jun 2025; method and limitations in docs/forecast_results.md.